Managing people and resources

Delegate the task, never the accountability. The PM holds the high-risk work, hands the daily operation to the APM, and uses experts for judgment, each with written decision rights and a weekly check.

WHO LEADS WHICH WORKSTREAMS

PM	Design · Prize purse · Reporting · Subcontractors · Pipeline QA
APM · operations	Platform · Challenge.gov · Info session · Competitor management · Convening
Marketing & comms	Website · Outreach · Winner announcement
Review lead	Judging & technical review
Internal SMEs	Technical webinar
Client agency	Approves every gate; federal judges decide awards
CoECI (COR)	Copied on every client communication; receives reports

PM and APM each lead five; give them a deputy or extra support. Full matrix on page 11.

THE PM KEEPS · HIGHEST RISK FIRST

1. **Client and CoECI relationship.** CoECI copied always; scope to the COR in writing — HIGHEST
2. **Prize money.** Payer, payee list and every disbursement — HIGHEST
3. **Award integrity.** Conflicts screened; federal judges decide, on record — HIGH
4. **Approval gates.** Nothing public without the client's sign-off — HIGH
5. **Scope, budget, schedule.** Slips on public dates go to the COR with options — HIGH
6. **Rules and legal terms.** Settled with agency counsel; design document cleared — MEDIUM
7. **Subcontractors.** Reviewed before the client sees it; work share tracked — MEDIUM
8. **Pipeline check.** Signs off assumptions and outreach QA — MEDIUM

DELEGATE, WITH GUARDRAILS

APM · challenge operations

Platform, inbox and FAQ drafts, Challenge.gov updates, logistics, reviewer paperwork, agendas and notes within 24 hours, trackers.

GUARDRAIL Drafts anything that commits FedTech; the PM sends it.

Marketing and comms

Outreach, site copy, promotion, winner announcement content.

GUARDRAIL Every public item passes its gate and the Workflow 15 check.

Internal SMEs

Problem framing, technical accuracy, draft criteria, webinar content.

GUARDRAIL Time-boxed hours; advise only; no scoring where FedTech has a conflict.

External SMEs and reviewers

Scoring, calibration, presentations, network introductions.

GUARDRAIL Conflict-screened each stage; NDA; honoraria agreed up front.

Rule of thumb: if it reaches the client, moves money, changes an award or commits FedTech to new work, the PM decides.

Delegates decide routine calls within approved scope and copy.

Delegates recommend anything touching a gate, the schedule or a solver dispute.

Escalate at once: scope, money, conflicts, client or CoECI concerns.